Lesson notes · for you

One step at a time

AI agents · Primary school · Lesson 2

Time
20 min

Materials
Small cards or pieces of paper; A pen; Someone at home or a friend

Learning goals

- Break a big job into small steps.
- Put steps in the right order.
- Stop and check when a step goes wrong.

Activity: Mixed-up steps

1. Warm-up (3 min): Socks before shoes: think of two more pairs of steps where the order matters, such as washing your hands before eating.
2. Write (5 min): Choose a job with at least five steps, such as making tea or planting a seed. Write each step on its own small card.
3. Swap (7 min): Mix up your cards and give them to a partner. They put them in order; then check together and talk about any step they put in the wrong place.
4. Check card (5 min): Add one card saying where the job could go wrong, such as “Is the water boiling?”, and what to do if the answer is no.

Choose a safe job: ask a grown-up before using a kettle or a stove for real.

Discussion

- When does the order of steps matter most?
- What should a helper do when a step goes wrong?
- Which of your jobs at home has the most steps?

Check yourself

- Write three steps of a job in order, and one place it could go wrong.

Try it this week
Write the steps for a job at home, such as making tea, on small cards. Mix them up and ask someone to put them in order. Which steps must come first, and where could the job go wrong?

Worksheet

One step at a time

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **The timetable tool says: no school on Saturday. What should the helper do next?**

◯ Stop and tell you there's no school ◯ Ask the weather tool instead

◯ Set the reminder anyway

2 **Put the steps for planning the class trip to Dala in order.**

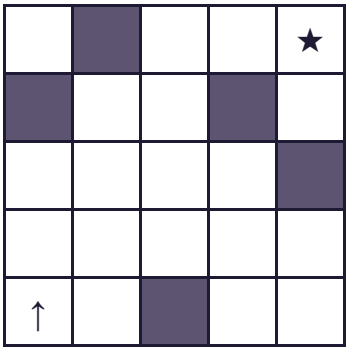
☐ Check the weather in Dala

☐ Find the way to Dala

☐ Send the message to the families

☐ Ask the teacher if the plan is OK

3 **The order of the cards matters. Get the robot round the walls to the star.**



Cut out cards (↑ forward, ↶ turn left, ↷ turn right) and lay out a program that takes the robot to the ★. Write it here:

_____

_____

4 **The order of the steps doesn't matter, as long as every step gets done.**

◯ True ◯ False

5 **Complete the sentences.**

A good helper finds things out _____, then acts. When a step goes wrong, it _____ and checks.

Word bank: stops · hurries · first · last

✎ **Think of a time when doing steps in the wrong order went wrong, at home or at school. What should have come first? You can write a few words, or just think about it.**

_____

_____

_____

Check your answers

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1 **Stop and tell you there's no school**

The first step went wrong, so the helper should stop and tell you, not carry on.

2 **Top to bottom: 2, 1, 4, 3**

Find things out first (the way, the weather), let a person agree, and only then act by sending the message.

3 **Any program that takes the robot to the ★ with 8 cards or fewer.**

One way: forward two, turn right, forward two, turn left, forward two, turn right, forward two.

4 **False**

Order matters: socks before shoes, and finding out before acting.

5 **A good helper finds things out first, then acts. When a step goes wrong, it stops and checks.**

Find out first, then act; and when a step fails, stop and check instead of carrying on.